

EVERYTHING WRONG

Tribe Nears Longest Loss Skein Since '52

By LESTER KOELLING
News Sportswriter

ST. PAUL—An impartial observer sitting in Midway Stadium here last night suggested that some sort of evil spirit has infested the personnel of the Indianapolis Indians.

"I've never seen any team have so many bad breaks as this one," said the man. "There must be some kind of a hex on them."

The observation came shortly after the Indians had lost their fourth straight one-run decision by a 5-4 score and their sixth by any margin. The man has seen the Indians lose before, but never by such a quirk of fortune as last night.

If Owne Bush, Tribe president, had been here, he probably would have injected his favorite philosophy of "sometimes you can't win for losin', and sometimes you can't lose for winnin'."

Birdie Tebbetts probably would have brought out his pet version of baseball as "a game of inches," and Kerby Farrell probably would have summarized the situation by saying, "When you're down, nothing goes right, and when you're winning, nothing goes wrong."

All Manager Andy Cohen could say was, "you've got to give the boys credit. They hung in there and gave everything they had. Things like this happen, but they can start going the other way just as easily and quickly."

UNEXPECTED CATCH KILLS RALLY

Of all the observations, the one Tebbetts might have made fits the situation most aptly. With two runners on base in the ninth and two out, Neil Chrisley slammed a long one into left center. Just inches longer and it would have been a certain double sending in the tying potential winning runs.

But Granny Gladstone, playing his first game since June 24, made a long run, a desperate lunge to grasp the ball overhead, and then retained possession as he crashed into the fence. That was the tapper to an evening of frustration that saw the Indians constantly threatening but seldom producing.

The irony of Gladstone's catch lay in an injury to Crawford Davidson, the starting left-fielder for St. Paul. Chances are that Davidson, a starter more for his hitting than his fielding, never would have caught up with the ball.

Can Do It, at Shakamak

ON, News Sportswriter

TRIBE BOX SCORE

INDIANAPOLIS (4)

	*B	Ave	AB	BB	R	H	O	A	E
Valdivia, ss	234	2	1	0	1	2	7	0	0
bPihavich, c	203	2	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Garcia, 2b	294	3	1	0	0	2	3	1	1
Chisley, lf	342	4	0	0	0	2	1	1	0
Delsing, cf	287	4	0	1	1	1	0	0	0
Melo, lb	273	4	0	1	1	9	2	1	0
Glendon, c	147	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Ditusa, rf	288	2	1	0	0	1	0	0	0
Jackson, lb	218	0	0	0	0	2	0	0	0
Romano, c	271	4	0	1	1	5	0	0	0
Williams, 3b	278	4	0	1	2	1	0	0	0
McDonald, p	158	2	0	1	1	1	0	0	0
Spencer, c	390	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Spencer, p	278	0	0	0	0	1	0	0	0
dHainston, c	273	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	0
eBayer, c	120	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

ST. PAUL (5)

	*B	Ave	AB	BB	R	H	O	A	E
Curry, 2b	319	4	0	0	1	3	4	0	0
Laine, rf	310	4	0	1	2	5	0	0	0
Larker, lb	328	4	0	1	1	6	0	1	1
Gier, 3b	287	4	0	1	1	0	1	0	0
Davidson, lf	239	2	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Gladstone, cf	251	2	0	0	0	0	1	0	0
Glenn, cf	279	4	0	1	2	3	0	0	0
Lillis, ss	262	3	0	1	2	2	3	0	0
Sherry, c	250	3	0	0	1	6	0	0	0
Negray, p	3	0	0	0	1	0	0	0	0
Waters, p	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

33 3 4 10 24 13 3

*At start of game.
*Struck out for McDonald in 7th.
*Grounded out for Valdivia in 7th.
*Glen for Melo in 8th.
*Singled for Spencer in 9th.
*Run for Hainston in 9th.
Indianapolis..... 000 010 210-4
St. Paul..... 000 011 000-5
Runs batted in-Larker, Glenn, Garcia
2. Laine, Lillis, Pihavich, Melo, Two-Base Hit-Williams, 2. Curry, Delsing, Three-Base Hit-McDonald, Glenn, Home Run-Laine, Sacrifice Fly-Garcia, Double Play-Gier to Curry to Larker; Lillis to Curry to Larker. Left on Base-Indianapolis 8, St. Paul 4.
PITCHING SUMMARY
IP H R ER BB SO WP
McDonald..... 6 10 5 4 0 3 0
Spencer..... 2 0 0 0 0 2 0
Negray..... 7 7 3 3 2 5 1
Waters..... 2 3 1 1 1 1 0
Winning Pitcher-Negray (9-4), Laine
Pitcher-McDonald (5-3), Umpires-Stewart, Carrigan and Van Keuren. Time-2:11.
Attendance-1,580.

So an injury became a blessing in disguise for the Saints.

SAINTS' GAMBLE REALLY PAYS OFF

Some evidence on the theory expounded by Farrell was Manager Max Macon's daring gamble on permitting Mel Waters, a right-hander, to pitch to Chrisley when he had a southpaw ready in the bullpen.

"I couldn't believe my eyes when I saw Waters still in there," said Neil. "Did you see me run up to the plate? I wanted to get there before Macon changed his mind."

The gamble paid off, but just barely, because the Saints are hot now and can't do anything wrong. And, like Manager Cohen surmised, "If I had done that, there would have been a base hit sure as green apples, and then I would have been blasted all over the place."

One has to agree with Cohen that unlimited credit is due the Indians in their losing fight against all sorts of adversities. True, they butchered the first inning when two errors and four hits pushed the Saints into a 3-0 lead, but this was one time when the Indians refused to remain docile and submissive.

Still, the Indians faulted their comeback trail by frequent failures in scoring situations. They had runners on base in all but the sixth inning and added two more "grounded double plays" to their staggering total. The loss terminated a five-game winning streak for Jim McDonald, and unless they win tonight the Indians will be in their longest losing streak since 1952.